

Word family: **routine / routines / routinely / routinize / routinized / routinization**

Base word: routine

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **adjective**

Related forms:

routinely (adv.) — 例行地；慣常地

routinize / routinise (v.) — 使例行化；使成為固定程序

routinized / routinised (adj.) — 已例行化的；程序化的

routinization / routinisation (n.) — 例行化；程序化

Useful expressions / extensions:

daily routine

morning routine

bedtime routine

work routine

exercise routine

routine task

routine check

routine procedure

routine maintenance

routine operation

routine question

fall into a routine

get into a routine

break a routine

change your routine

be trapped in routine

out of routine

routinely check / inspect / review

Meaning in this passage

> Adults often get trapped in **routine**, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here, **routine** means:

a fixed and repeated way of living or doing things — 固定而重複的生活模式；日常規律

The sentence suggests that adults can become too attached to doing the same things in the same way every day.

****中文翻譯：****

成年人往往容易陷入****一成不變的日常規律 / 固定生活模式****，而像 Leo 這樣的孩子卻可以把一個普通的下午變成一場小小的冒險。

So here:

**routine = 固定、重複、習慣性的生活安排**

1. **routine (固定日常安排) — 日常規律；固定程序**

This is the core noun meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Adults often get trapped in ****routine****.

成年人往往容易陷入****一成不變的日常規律****。

Practice 2

> I follow the same ****routine**** every morning.

我每天早上都按照相同的****固定程序****。

Practice 3

> After a few weeks, the new schedule became part of my ****routine****.

幾星期後，新的時間表成為了我****日常生活的一部分****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine = 經常重複、通常按固定次序進行的一系列活動或生活安排****

2. **daily routine — 日常作息；每日例行安排**

Practice 1

> Exercise is part of my ****daily routine****.

運動是我****每日作息****的一部分。

Practice 2

> Her **daily routine** has changed since she started working from home.

自從她開始在家工作後，她的**日常作息**改變了。

MCQ-ready definition:

daily routine = 每天通常按固定方式進行的一系列活動

3. **morning routine** — 早晨例行習慣

Practice 1

> My **morning routine** includes coffee and a short walk.

我的**早晨例行習慣**包括喝咖啡和散步一會兒。

Practice 2

> Children often benefit from a regular **morning routine**.

孩子通常會受益於固定的**早晨作息**。

MCQ-ready definition:

morning routine = 每天早上慣常重複進行的一系列活動

4. **bedtime routine** — 睡前習慣；睡前程序

Practice 1

> Reading is part of his **bedtime routine**.

閱讀是他的**睡前習慣**之一。

Practice 2

> A calm **bedtime routine** can help children sleep better.

平靜的**睡前程序**可以幫助孩子睡得更好。

MCQ-ready definition:

****bedtime routine = 每晚睡覺前慣常進行的一系列活動****

5. ****work routine — 工作例行程序****

Practice 1

> It took me a few days to get used to the new ****work routine****.

我花了幾天才習慣新的****工作流程****。

Practice 2

> Her ****work routine**** is fairly predictable.

她的****工作日常程序****相當固定。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****work routine = 工作中經常重複進行的固定步驟或安排****

6. ****exercise routine — 固定運動計劃；運動程序****

Practice 1

> He follows a simple ****exercise routine**** every evening.

他每天晚上都做一套簡單的****固定運動****。

Practice 2

> She changed her ****exercise routine**** to avoid boredom.

她改變了自己的****運動安排****，以免感到沉悶。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exercise routine = 按固定方式或次序重複進行的一套運動****

7. ****fall into a routine — 逐漸形成固定模式****

Practice 1

> After a month, we **fell into a routine**.

一個月後，我們逐漸**形成了固定生活模式**。

Practice 2

> It's easy to **fall into a routine** when every day looks the same.

當每天都差不多時，很容易**陷入固定模式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fall into a routine = 不知不覺開始按照同一套固定方式生活或做事

8. **get into a routine** — 建立 / 進入固定作息

Usually more neutral or positive than **fall into a routine**.

Practice 1

> It took me a week to **get into a routine**.

我花了一星期才**建立起固定作息**。

Practice 2

> Once you **get into a routine**, studying becomes easier.

一旦你**建立固定習慣**，學習就會變得容易一些。

MCQ-ready definition:

get into a routine = 開始建立並習慣一套固定、重複的做事方式

9. **break your routine** — 打破日常規律；改變固定模式

Practice 1

> Travelling helps me **break my routine**.

旅行可以幫助我**打破一成不變的日常生活**。

Practice 2

> Try doing something different to **break the routine**.

試試做點不同的事來**打破固定模式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

break a routine = 暫時停止或改變原本固定重複的生活或做事方式

10. **change your routine** — 改變作息 / 固定安排

Practice 1

> I need to **change my routine** and exercise more.

我需要**改變生活作息**，多做運動。

Practice 2

> A small change in **routine** can make life feel fresher.

日常安排的一點小改變可以令生活感覺更新鮮。

MCQ-ready definition:

change your routine = 改變平常固定的活動次序或生活安排

11. **routine** (adjective : 例行的) — 例行的；常規的

This is a major adjective sense.

Practice 1

> The doctor performed a **routine examination**.

醫生進行了一次**例行檢查**。

Practice 2

> This is just a **routine procedure**.

這只是一項**常規程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

routine = 按照正常程序定期或慣常進行的，而不是特殊或緊急的

12. **routine check — 例行檢查**

Practice 1

> The mechanic carried out a **routine check** on the car.

技工為汽車進行了**例行檢查**。

Practice 2

> During a **routine check**, the doctor noticed something unusual.

在一次**例行檢查**中，醫生注意到一些異常情況。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine check = 按正常安排定期進行、並非因特別問題而作出的檢查****

13. **routine test / examination — 常規檢測 / 檢查**

Practice 1

> The blood test was completely **routine**.

這項血液檢查完全是**常規性的**。

Practice 2

> She went to hospital for a **routine examination**.

她到醫院接受**例行檢查**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine test/examination = 按正常醫療或工作程序進行的標準檢查****

14. **routine procedure — 常規程序**

Practice 1

> The operation is now considered a **routine procedure**.

這項手術現在被視為一項**常規程序**。

Practice 2

> Changing the password is a **routine security procedure**.

更改密碼是一項**例行保安程序**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine procedure = 經常按標準方法進行、不屬特殊情況的程序****

15. **routine maintenance — 例行保養；常規維修**

Practice 1

> The machine requires regular **routine maintenance**.

這部機器需要定期進行**例行保養**。

Practice 2

> The system was temporarily shut down for **routine maintenance**.

系統因進行**常規維護**而暫時關閉。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine maintenance = 為保持設備正常運作而定期進行的標準保養工作****

16. **routine task — 例行工作；日常工作**

Practice 1

> Checking emails is a **routine task** for many office workers.

查看電郵是很多辦公室員工的**日常例行工作**。

Practice 2

> The software automates several **routine tasks**.

這款軟件可以自動處理幾項**例行工作**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine task = 經常重複、通常不需要特別處理的工作****

17. ****routine decision / matter — 普通、常規的決定 / 事項****

Practice 1

> Most of these are ****routine matters****.

這些大多只是****一般例行事項****。

Practice 2

> The manager handles ****routine decisions**** without consulting the director.

經理處理****日常常規決定****時不需要請示董事。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine = 普通、慣常、不屬特別或異常情況的****

18. ****routine (乏味、缺乏變化的) — 平淡重複的 ; 公式化的****

Depending on context, ****routine**** can carry a mildly negative sense.

Practice 1

> The job became ****routine**** after a few months.

幾個月後，這份工作變得****重複而乏味****。

Practice 2

> His performance felt rather ****routine****.

他的表現令人覺得有點****公式化，缺乏新意****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routine = 因過度熟悉、重複而變得普通、缺乏新鮮感或挑戰性的****

This negative shade is especially relevant to your passage.

19. ****routinely** — 例行地；經常地******

Practice 1

> The equipment is ****routinely inspected****.

這些設備會接受****例行檢查****。

Practice 2

> Staff ****routinely check**** the system for errors.

員工會****定期 / 例行地檢查****系統是否有錯誤。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routinely** = 按慣常程序、定期或經常地******

20. ****routinely** (通常；一向) — 慣常地；通常******

It can also simply mean that something happens regularly.

Practice 1

> She ****routinely works**** late on Fridays.

她星期五****通常都會****工作至很晚。

Practice 2

> The company ****routinely receives**** hundreds of applications.

公司****經常****收到數百份申請。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****routinely** = 某件事經常發生，已成為正常模式******

21. ****routinize / routinise** — 使例行化；使成固定程序******

More formal and relatively lower-frequency.

Practice 1

> The company tried to **routinize** simple administrative tasks.

公司嘗試把簡單行政工作**程序化 / 例行化**。

Practice 2

> Technology can **routinize** work that once required constant attention.

科技可以把以前需要持續留意的工作**變成固定程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

routinize = 使某項活動變成固定、標準化並反覆進行的程序

22. **routinized** — 例行化的；程序化的

Practice 1

> Much of the work has become highly **routinized**.

大部分工作已經變得高度**程序化**。

Practice 2

> The process is now completely **routinized**.

這個流程現在已經完全**例行化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

routinized = 已被安排成固定、標準化程序的

23. **routinization** — 例行化；程序化

Formal/academic.

Practice 1

> The **routinization** of repetitive tasks improved efficiency.

重複工作的**程序化**提高了效率。

Practice 2

> Too much **routinization** can reduce creativity.

過度**例行化**可能降低創意。

MCQ-ready definition:

routinization = 把活動變成固定、標準和反覆程序的過程

Important distinction 1: **routine** vs **habit**

These overlap, but they are not the same.

habit

usually one repeated behaviour:

> checking your phone before bed

睡前看手機的習慣

routine

often a **series of repeated activities**:

> shower → breakfast → coffee → work

一整套日常流程

So:

> brushing your teeth is a **habit**

while:

> your whole morning sequence is a **routine**

Important distinction 2: **routine** vs **schedule**

routine

focuses on **what you repeatedly do and in what pattern**.

schedule

focuses on **when activities are planned to happen**.

> My morning **routine** includes exercise.

我的早晨習慣包括運動。

> My **schedule** says I have a meeting at ten.

我的時間表顯示十點有會議。

Important distinction 3: **routine vs procedure**

routine

a repeated regular pattern.

procedure

a prescribed sequence of steps for performing a task.

> morning **routine**

早晨作息

> emergency **procedure**

緊急程序

A procedure may become routine, but the concepts are not identical.

Important distinction 4: **routine vs ritual**

routine

practical and regular.

ritual

may have ceremonial, symbolic, emotional, or highly fixed meaning.

> my morning ****routine****

我的早晨作息

> a religious ****ritual****

宗教儀式

Informally, ****ritual**** can also describe a personally meaningful repeated habit:

> our Sunday coffee ritual

我們每星期日喝咖啡的固定小儀式

Important distinction 5: ****routine vs regular****

****routine****

can be noun or adjective and often means habitual/standard.

****regular****

often means occurring at consistent intervals or normal.

> a ****routine check****

例行檢查

> ****regular checks****

定期檢查

They overlap strongly, but ****routine**** more clearly suggests this is standard procedure.

Important distinction 6: ****routine vs ordinary****

****ordinary****

means not unusual or special.

****routine****

means standard because it happens regularly.

> an **ordinary day**

普通的一天

> a **routine inspection**

例行檢查

Something can be ordinary without being repeated according to a routine.

Important distinction 7: **routine** vs **repetitive**

routine

can be neutral or positive.

> a healthy morning routine

健康的早晨習慣

repetitive

specifically emphasizes repetition and often sounds negative.

> repetitive work

重複乏味的工作

So **routine** is not automatically negative.

Important distinction 8: **get into a routine** vs **get trapped in routine**

This is especially important for your sentence.

get into a routine

usually neutral/positive:

> I finally **got into a good routine**.

我終於建立了良好的固定作息。

get trapped in routine

negative:

> I became **trapped in routine**.

我被一成不變的生活模式困住了。

The negativity comes mainly from **trapped**, not from **routine** itself.

Important distinction 9: **routine noun vs routine adjective**

Noun

> My morning **routine** takes an hour.

我的早晨**固定程序**需時一小時。

Adjective

> It was a **routine check**.

那是一次**例行檢查**。

Same spelling, different grammatical function.

Important distinction 10: **routine procedure is not redundant**

It can sound repetitive to learners because both words suggest regularity, but they contribute different meanings:

* **routine** = ordinary/standard, not exceptional

* **procedure** = prescribed series of steps

So:

> a **routine procedure**

means:

a standard procedure commonly carried out

Important distinction 11: **routine vs mundane**

routine

regular/repeated

mundane

dull, ordinary, lacking excitement

> routine tasks

例行工作

> mundane tasks

平凡沉悶的工作

Something can be routine without being mundane, although they often overlap.

Important distinction 12: **routine vs monotonous**

monotonous

specifically means boring because there is little variation.

routine

simply means regular or repeated, though context may make it sound dull.

In your passage:

> trapped in routine

suggests something close to **monotony**, but **routine** itself remains broader.

Family-extension note

Routine is a good polysemy candidate, though its structure is fairly compact.

There are three main modern branches:

1. **noun: repeated pattern**

- * daily routine
- * morning routine
- * work routine

2. **adjective: standard/regular**

- * routine check
- * routine procedure
- * routine maintenance

3. **negative contextual extension**

- * routine work
- * trapped in routine
- * life becoming routine

The third does **not** require a completely separate dictionary meaning every time. It develops from the idea that **something repeated and predictable can become dull or restrictive**.

Related forms such as **routinely** and **routinization** extend the same concept into frequency and standardization.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
routine (noun)	日常規律；固定程序	repeated pattern	
daily routine	每日作息	daily pattern	
morning routine	早晨習慣	morning pattern	
bedtime routine	睡前程序	pre-sleep pattern	
work routine	工作例行程序	repeated work pattern	
exercise routine	固定運動計劃	repeated exercise set	
fall into a routine	逐漸形成固定模式	enter habitual pattern	
get into a routine	建立固定作息	establish regular pattern	
break the routine	打破固定模式	interrupt repetition	
change your routine	改變作息	alter habitual pattern	
routine check	例行檢查	standard check	

routine procedure	常規程序	standard procedure	
routine maintenance	例行保養	standard maintenance	
routine task	例行工作	regularly repeated task	
routine matter	一般例行事項	ordinary standard matter	
routine (dull)	重複乏味的；公式化的	overly predictable	
routinely	例行地；經常地	regularly	
routinize	使例行化	make standard/repeated	
routinized	已程序化的	made routine	
routinization	例行化；程序化	process of making routine	

For your original sentence

> Adults often get trapped in ****routine****, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here:

****routine = 固定、重複、一成不變的日常生活模式****

The important nuance is that ****routine is not inherently negative****.

A routine can actually be useful:

> a healthy morning routine

> 健康的早晨作息

But in:

> ****get trapped in routine****

the metaphor makes it negative:

****repetition → predictability → less spontaneity → feeling restricted****

So the natural Traditional Chinese is:

> 成年人往往容易陷入****一成不變的日常生活模式****.....

That contrast sets up Leo perfectly: adults may become overly predictable, while he can turn an ordinary afternoon into an adventure.